UPSC CIVIL SERVICES · DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS

UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

MONDAY, 26 OCTOBER 2026

14 must-know stories, 25 Prelims facts, 17 editorials and 14 explainers, picked from 890 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

Open this brief online: summaries, Ask Intel and practice MCQs

MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Delhi SIR: Why is ECI forcing excluded voters to submit Form 6 as first-time voters? Supreme Court

The Election Commission of India stated in a Supreme Court counter-affidavit that all special intensive revision decisions were unanimous. The joint affidavit by Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi rejected allegations of unilateral action. Petitions had alleged that Kumar acted unilaterally and that the poll panel violated its statutory decision-making process under the 2023 Act. The ECI denied amending the statutory Form 6 for voter enrolment, stating the additional declaration was a separate prescribed document. The three disputed SIR orders were issued on June 24, 2025, October 27, 2025, and May 14, 2026, under Article 324 and Section 18. The affidavit asserted that individual suggestions, queries, or objections do not constitute decisions of the Commission under Section 18. Letters sent by commissioners Sandhu and Joshi to the Cabinet Secretary concerned deputation and work allocation rather than policy differences. The additional declaration, designated Annexure D and later Annexure IV, aimed to facilitate linking applicants with earlier electoral rolls. The opposition petition sought an independent time-bound inquiry into alleged unilateral power exercise and suspension of the ongoing SIR.

When: 2026-10-26 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Gyanesh Kumar, Sukhbir Singh Sandhu, Vivek Joshi, Bhanu Prakash Yeturu · **Prelims:** The three SIR orders were issued on June 24, 2025, October 27, 2025, and May 14, 2026.; The additional declaration attached to Form 6 was designated as Annexure D and later substituted with Annexure IV.; Section 18 of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners Act, 2023 governs ECI decision-making.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Tests the statutory interpretation of collective decision-making provisions under Section 18 of the 2023 Election Commission Act.; Addresses judicial scrutiny into the administrative autonomy and internal functioning of India's poll panel.*

Static — The Election Commission of India is an autonomous constitutional body established under Article 324 of the Constitution to superintend and conduct elections. The Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners Act, 2023 governs the appointment, conditions of service, and term of office of election commissioners. Section 18 of the 2023 Act mandates that the Election Commission shall, as far as possible, take decisions unanimously, with differences resolved by majority.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

Bar & Bench: read the source · free copy on hindustantimes.com · also reported by NDTV, Hindustan Times, India Today

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Media groups challenge India’s privacy law at top court

The Supreme Court sought a response from the Union government on a petition challenging provisions of the Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act and DPDP Rules. The petition was filed by the Digital News Publishers Association (DNPA), representing legacy media organisations. Petitioners argued that the law and its rules allegedly infringe press freedom and the right to information. The plea seeks to strike down several provisions as unconstitutional due to the absence of an exemption for journalistic activities. Advocate Madhavi Divan stated that lacking journalistic exemptions could impede news reporting, harm investigative journalism, and compromise source confidentiality. The petition noted that strict consent requirements from data principals could make routine news gathering, television journalism, and time-sensitive reporting unworkable. The association also challenged the amendment to Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information (RTI) Act for restricting access to public officials' information. Concerns were further raised regarding the Centre's powers to requisition information under the DPDP Act, impacting newsrooms. A bench led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant issued the notice and listed the matter for further hearing on November 17.

When: 2026-10-26 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Supreme Court, Digital News Publishers Association (DNPA), Madhavi Divan, Chief Justice of India Surya Kant · **Prelims:** The petition was filed by the Digital News Publishers Association (DNPA).; The bench hearing the case was headed

by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant.; The petition challenges provisions of the DPDP Act, DPDP Rules, and an amendment to Section 8(1)(j) of the RTI Act.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the tension between individual data privacy rights and freedom of the press in India.; Brings judicial scrutiny to the practical implications of the DPDP Act on newsrooms, live reporting, and investigative journalism.*

Static — The Supreme Court of India is the highest judicial forum and final court of appeal under the Constitution of India, established under Article 124. The Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act governs the processing of digital personal data in a manner that recognizes both individuals' privacy rights and the need to process personal data for lawful purposes. The Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005 empowers citizens to secure access to information under the control of public authorities, promoting transparency and accountability.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Judgment

Al Jazeera: read the source · free copy on deccanherald.com · also reported by The Hindu, Outlook India, BMI

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Refers Water Dispute Case to Constitution Bench for Interpretation of Constitutional Provisions. The suit involves significant legal questions regarding the enforcement of interim orders of the Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal under the Inter-Stat

The matter was put in the news because the suit involves important legal questions about enforcing interim tribunal orders under the Inter-State Water Disputes framework. The Supreme Court has referred a water dispute case concerning the Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal to a Constitution Bench to interpret key constitutional provisions.

When: 2026-10-26 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court · **Prelims:** The case involves the Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal.; The dispute relates to the Inter-State Water Disputes framework.; The matter has been referred to a Constitution Bench.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It clarifies the scope of judicial review and enforcement powers regarding inter-state tribunal orders.; It addresses critical questions of federalism and resource sharing between riparian states.*

Static — Article 145(3) of the Constitution mandates that a bench consisting of at least five judges shall sit for cases involving a substantial question of law as to the interpretation of the Constitution. Article 262 of the Indian Constitution empowers Parliament to provide by law for the adjudication of any dispute relating to the use, distribution or control of inter-state rivers. The Inter-State Water Disputes Act, 1956 provides the legal mechanism for setting up ad-hoc tribunals to resolve water sharing disputes between states.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

Lawtext: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

CEC can be removed only like a Supreme Court judge, ECI tells top court

The Election Commission of India stated in the Supreme Court that all Special Intensive Revision exercise decisions were taken unanimously by all three poll panel members. The poll panel defended Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, arguing a plea to restrain him is based on a single news report and not maintainable. The ECI stressed that the CEC can be removed from office only in the same manner and on the same grounds as a Supreme Court judge. The ECI clarified that Form 6 for enrolling new voters has not been amended by them since only the Centre holds the power to amend it. The Commission admitted the online display could be misread as an amendment, and announced the online application will be split into Form 6 and the declaration. The ECI explained that internal file notes, queries, or suggestions made during processing by the CEC or ECs do not constitute official Commission decisions. The poll panel clarified that unmapped voters do not need to attend hearings because Booth Level Officers will collect documents directly from their homes.

When: 2026-10-26 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Gyanesh Kumar, Sukhbir Singh Sandhu, Vivek Joshi, Election Commission of India, Supreme Court · **Prelims:** Form 6 is used to enroll new voters and can only be amended by the Centre.; The three current members of the poll panel named are CEC Gyanesh Kumar, and Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi.; An expert committee with specialists from IIT and IISc has been set up to check compliance for ECINet.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reaffirms the statutory security of tenure and independence of the Chief Election Commissioner under Indian law.; Clarifies administrative procedures and internal decision-making mechanisms within the multi-member Election Commission of India.*

Static — Under Article 324 of the Constitution, the Election Commission of India is an autonomous constitutional body responsible for administering union and state election processes in India. The Chief Election Commissioner and Election Commissioners are appointed by the President, and the CEC enjoys protection from arbitrary removal similar to a Supreme Court judge. The 2023 Act regulates the appointment, conditions of service, and term of office of the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

The Hindu: read the source · free copy on thestatesman.com

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Chhattisgarh Dharma Swatantrya Act: Supreme Court Issues Notice On Challenge To Conversion Law

The Supreme Court initiated proceedings by issuing notice on the petition challenging the conversion law. The Supreme Court has issued a notice on a legal challenge against the constitutional validity of the Chhattisgarh Dharma Swatantrya Act, which regulates religious conversions.

When: 2026-10-26 · **Where:** Chhattisgarh · **Who:** Supreme Court · **Prelims:** The law in question is the Chhattisgarh Dharma Swatantrya Act.; The Supreme Court issued notice on the challenge to the conversion law.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It addresses the delicate balance between state regulation of religious conversions and individual fundamental rights under the Constitution.; The outcome of this case will have wider implications for similar freedom of religion legislations enacted across various Indian states.*

Static — Article 25 of the Constitution guarantees freedom of conscience and the right freely to profess, practise, and propagate religion, subject to public order, morality, and health. Freedom of religion is a fundamental right under Part III of the Constitution, ensuring protection against state interference in matters of faith. Several states in India have enacted Freedom of Religion Acts, commonly termed anti-conversion laws, to regulate religious conversions involving force, fraud, or allurement.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

LawChakra: read the source · also reported by The Siasat Daily

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Directs States & High Courts To Ensure Availability Of Washrooms, Ladies' Bar Rooms For...

The Supreme Court directed all States and High Courts to provide exclusive bar rooms and washrooms for women advocates in district, sub-divisional, and taluka courts. The directive applies wherever women lawyers practise, irrespective of their numerical strength, and must be implemented without dilution. A bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant emphasized that these facilities must be made available to ensure dedicated spaces and essential amenities. The court directed States to provide necessary funds and land wherever required for establishing these infrastructure facilities. High Court infrastructure committees have been asked to accord priority to the implementation of this directive. The facilities should preferably follow a uniform pattern across the country in all court complexes. Attorney General R Venkataramani was designated as the nodal authority to consolidate progress reports from States and High Courts and coordinate compliance. The bench scheduled the next hearing in the matter for December 2.

When: 2026-10-26 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, Attorney General R Venkataramani · **Prelims:** Chief Justice of India Surya Kant headed the bench.; Attorney General R Venkataramani was designated as the nodal authority.; The next hearing in the matter is scheduled for December 2.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Promotes gender inclusivity and professional dignity for women lawyers in the subordinate judiciary.; Addresses systemic infrastructural deficits that hinder women's participation in the legal profession at the grassroots level.*

Static — District judiciary infrastructure is funded primarily through centrally sponsored schemes and state budgets, overseen by High Court infrastructure committees. High Courts exercise administrative control over subordinate courts under Article 235 of the Constitution of India. The Attorney General for India is appointed under Article 76 of the Constitution as the highest law officer and legal advisor to the government.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

dailypioneer.com: read the source

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India-US trade deal: Most discussions concluded, agreement being fine-tuned

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal announced in The Hague that India and the US have concluded most discussions for a proposed bilateral trade pact and are fine-tuning the agreement. The two nations had announced the framework for the first phase of the bilateral trade agreement on February 7, which was followed by further negotiations due to changes in the US tariff landscape. Under the initial framework, the US reduced tariffs on Indian goods from 50 per cent to 18 per cent, with zero tariffs planned for generic pharmaceuticals, gems, diamonds, and aircraft parts. In return, India committed to eliminate or reduce tariffs on all US industrial goods, alongside various food and agricultural products like tree nuts, fruit, and dried distillers' grains. India also intends to purchase $500 billion worth of US energy products, aircraft, precious metals, technology products, and coking coal over five years. The framework addresses non-tariff barriers, with India agreeing to tackle hurdles for US medical devices, remove restrictive import licensing for ICT products, and address digital trade barriers.

When: October 2026 · **Where:** The Hague, Netherlands, and Washington, USA · **Who:** Piyush Goyal, Jamieson Greer, Rajesh Agrawal · **Prelims:** The US cut tariffs on Indian goods from 50 per cent to 18 per cent under the February framework.; India intends to buy $500 billion worth of US energy, aircraft, precious metals, technology, and coking coal over five years.; Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal led talks with US officials in Washington from October 15 to 17.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It marks a major milestone in economic ties between India and the United States, potentially boosting bilateral commerce significantly.; The pact addresses critical market access issues, including tariff reductions on industrial and agricultural goods, and sets terms for critical technology cooperation.*

Static — Bilateral Trade Agreements (BTAs) are economic treaties between two nations aimed at reducing or eliminating tariffs and non-tariff barriers to boost trade and investment. The US Trade Representative (USTR) is the agency responsible for developing and recommending US trade policy to the President, conducting trade negotiations, and administering trade agreements. Free Trade Agreements (FTAs) involve concessions on custom duties and trade rules between partner countries, managed under multilateral frameworks like the World Trade Organization (WTO) rules.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

BusinessLine: read the source · free copy on msn.com · also reported by Economic Times, The Hindu

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India To Host BRICS Summit From Tomorrow; Putin and Xi Jinping's Visit Crucial

The summit is scheduled to begin tomorrow, making the arrival of leaders like Putin and Xi Jinping a focal point of current news. India is hosting the upcoming BRICS Summit starting tomorrow, with significant attention on the visits of key global leaders.

When: Starting tomorrow (2026-10-27) · **Where:** India · **Who:** Vladimir Putin, Xi Jinping, India · **Prelims:** India is hosting the BRICS Summit starting tomorrow.; Vladimir Putin and Xi Jinping are among the key leaders visiting for the summit.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights India's growing diplomatic footprint and its role in multilateral forums.; Provides a crucial platform for bilateral and plurilateral engagement between India, Russia, and China.*

Static — BRICS is an intergovernmental organisation comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa, with several new partner countries added recently. The grouping was originally formed as BRIC in 2009 before South Africa joined in 2010 to form BRICS. The primary aim of BRICS is to promote peace, security, development, and cooperation among emerging market economies.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

IndianMandarins: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Jaishankar to attend G20, Quad meets in US

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar will travel to Atlanta to attend the G20 and Quad foreign ministers' meetings. The meetings are scheduled to take place on October 30 to 31 and will be hosted by US Secretary of State Marco Rubio. This gathering signals the strategic forum's resilience despite recent diplomatic turbulence between India and the US. This will be the second Quad foreign ministers' meeting of the year, following the event hosted by India in May. The ministers will outline the agenda for the upcoming Quad leaders' summit in Manila scheduled for next month. The Manila summit on November 16 will mark the first Quad leaders' summit in two years. The upcoming summit occurs amid maritime tensions between Manila and Beijing, and ahead of US President Donald Trump's visit to China.

When: October 30-31, 2026 · **Where:** Atlanta, USA · **Who:** S Jaishankar, Marco Rubio · **Prelims:** The Quad foreign ministers are meeting in Atlanta.; US Secretary of State Marco Rubio is hosting the October 30-31 meetings.; The Quad leaders' summit is scheduled to take place in Manila on November 16.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights ongoing high-level diplomatic engagement between India and the US despite recent bilateral turbulence.; Prepares the agenda for the first Quad leaders' summit in two years, crucial for Indo-Pacific security cooperation.*

Static — The Quadrilateral Security Dialogue (Quad) is a strategic security dialogue between Australia, India, Japan, and the United States. The grouping traces its origins back to the 2004 Indian Ocean tsunami relief coordination and was revived in 2017. The Quad aims to ensure a free, open, and inclusive Indo-Pacific region through diplomatic, economic, and security cooperation.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

Times of India: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India, EU seek to fast-track FTA signing in December

India and the European Union are working to meet a December deadline to sign their Free Trade Agreement. The push aims to sign the pact around December 17 or 18 in Brussels during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's expected visit. The European Commission proposed a fast-track procedure to expedite approval and avoid delays. The fast-track procedure suggests completing the legal process using the original English version instead of waiting for translations into 24 official EU languages. EU trade commissioner Maroš Šefcovic urged the Council of the European Union to approve this fast-track approach. Political-level negotiations for the FTA were concluded on January 27, 2026, during the 16th India-EU Summit in New Delhi. Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal is expected to visit Brussels to address procedural issues, following Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal's tour of Germany and the Netherlands.

When: December 2026 · **Where:** Brussels, New Delhi, Germany, Netherlands · **Who:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Maroš Šefcovic, Rajesh Agrawal, Piyush Goyal, David McAllister · **Prelims:** Bilateral trade in goods between India and the EU stood at €118 billion in 2025.; Trade in services between India and the EU amounted to €67 billion in 2025.; The FTA political-level conclusion took place on January 27, 2026, during the 16th India-EU Summit in New Delhi.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It forms a crucial economic pact often called the mother of all deals, covering a quarter of the global population and 25% of global GDP.; It expands market access for Indian exports including machinery, chemicals, textiles, and petroleum products to the EU's 27 member economies.*

Static — The European Union is a political and economic union of 27 member states located primarily in Europe, with a combined economy of approximately $23 trillion. Free Trade Agreements are pacts between two or more nations to reduce or eliminate barriers to imports and exports, such as tariffs and quotas. Bilateral trade between India and the EU covers significant volumes of goods, including machinery, chemicals, and textiles, alongside extensive trade in services.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

msn.com: read the source · also reported by Vietnam.vn

Economy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India Approves E100 Ethanol Fuel for Flex-Fuel Vehicles: What It Means for Carmakers and Buyers

The government has formally cleared the way for E100 fuel by amending the Central Motor Vehicles Rules, 1989. The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways notified the amendments on October 23 to promote flex-fuel vehicles, cut crude oil imports, and lower emissions. The core issue is expanding India's ethanol blending framework while restricting high-blend fuels exclusively to specially certified vehicles rather than standard petrol cars. The amendments alter fuel specifications, emission tables, and vehicle testing requirements, and raise the gross vehicle weight limit from 3,000 kg to 3,500 kg. Existing petrol cars and vehicles built only for E20 petrol are not permitted to use E85 or E100 fuels. Draft rules for this change were first published in April for a 30-day public consultation window before final notification. Automakers like Maruti Suzuki have already launched flex-fuel passenger vehicles such as the Wagon R Flex Fuel, while others are developing similar models. The ethanol blending programme aims to reduce crude import burdens on the current account deficit, backed by India's ethanol production capacity of nearly 2,000 crore litres.

When: October 23 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) · **Prelims:** MoRTH notified the Central Motor Vehicles Rules amendments on October 23.; The gross vehicle weight limit under the rules was raised from 3,000 kg to 3,500 kg.; India's total ethanol production capacity stands at nearly 2,000 crore litres.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides a clear regulatory framework for automobile manufacturers to launch and test high-blend flex-fuel vehicles in India.; Supports India's macro-economic goals by lowering imported crude oil dependence and reducing the current account deficit.*

Static — Ethanol blending programmes in India are spearheaded by the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas alongside the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways, aligning with national goals of energy security and carbon reduction. Flex-fuel vehicles (FFVs) feature internal combustion engines designed to run on more than one type of fuel, typically petrol-ethanol blends up to 100 percent ethanol. The Central Motor Vehicles Rules (CMVR) of 1989 regulate motor vehicle standards, licensing, registration, and safety and emission parameters across India under the Motor Vehicles Act.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Infrastructure & Energy · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

newsx.com: read the source · also reported by The Hindu, DNA India, ANI News, RuralVoice, Business Upturn, Ommcom News, PIB, The Siasat Daily

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Centre committed to reducing fiscal deficit, says FM Nirmala Sitharaman

Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman stated that the Centre is strongly committed to reducing the fiscal deficit through annual budgets. She highlighted that national debt will be limited to 50 per cent of the Gross Domestic Product by the year 2030. Addressing queries about national debt, she noted that every nation has faced debt challenges since the post-COVID period. The government is consistently implementing specific measures to bring down the Union Government's overall debt level. International organisations have reportedly acknowledged India's disciplined approach toward effective debt management.

When: 2026-10-26 · **Where:** Tiruchirappalli, Tamil Nadu · **Who:** Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman · **Prelims:** Target year set by the government to limit national debt to 50 per cent of GDP is 2030.; Union Finance Minister who made the announcement is Nirmala Sitharaman.; The announcement was made in Tiruchirappalli, Tamil Nadu.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reassures global and domestic markets about India's fiscal prudence and medium-term economic stability.; Provides a clear policy trajectory for debt consolidation leading up to 2030.*

Static — Fiscal deficit represents the total borrowing requirements of the government to meet its expenditures when total revenue falls short. The Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management (FRBM) Act aims to institutionalize financial discipline and reduce fiscal deficits. India's fiscal policy seeks to balance economic growth imperatives with macroeconomic stability and long-term debt sustainability.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

Business Standard: read the source · free copy on ptinews.com · also reported by Economic Times

Defence

GS3 MAKE NOTES

DAC clears capital acquisition proposals worth Rs 2.12 lakh crore for defence forces

The Defence Acquisition Council cleared capital acquisition proposals worth approximately Rs 2.12 lakh crore for the Indian armed forces. The decisions were taken during a meeting chaired by Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on October 26, 2026. A major focus is on indigenization, with nearly 82 percent of the total procurements planned from the Indian industry. For the Indian Army, approvals include High Mobility Vehicles, Self-Propelled Tracked Gun Systems, Light Multi Role Helicopters, and various drone systems. For the Indian Navy, approval was granted for the procurement of an Active Offboard Decoy System and major indigenous naval platforms. For the Indian Air Force, nods were given for helicopters, air defence systems, weapons, and Mobile X-Band Doppler Weather Radar Systems. The acquisitions aim to boost combat capabilities, logistic support, mobility in challenging terrains, and modern anti-missile defence for adversaries.

When: October 26, 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Defence Acquisition Council, Rajnath Singh, Ministry of Defence, Indian Army, Indian Navy, Indian Air Force · **Prelims:** Total estimated cost of approved proposals is around Rs 2,12,000 crore.; Share of procurement from Indian Industry is nearly 82%.; Active Offboard Decoy System was approved for the Indian Navy.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Significantly boosts domestic defence manufacturing by earmarking 82 percent of the Rs 2.12 lakh crore procurement for Indian industry.; Enhances multi-domain operational readiness and tactical mobility for the Army, Navy, and Air Force.*

Static — The Defence Acquisition Council is the apex decision-making body in the Ministry of Defence for deciding on new policies and capital acquisitions for the three services and the Indian Coast Guard. The DAC is chaired by the Union Defence Minister. Acceptance of Necessity granted by the DAC is the first step in the long capital procurement process, acting as an in-principle administrative approval.

Syllabus: GS3: Defence, Agriculture & Allied · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

PIB: read the source · free copy on newsonair.gov.in · also reported by Economic Times, OpenGov Asia, ThePrint

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Raksha Mantri calls for ‘Aatmanirbharta 2.0’, next leap in defence self-reliance, at SWAVLAMBAN 2026

The Defence Minister called for ‘Aatmanirbharta 2.0’ in the defence sector at the fifth edition of SWAVLAMBAN 2026 in New Delhi. The push aims to develop advanced technologies, strengthen R&D, and build resilient domestic supply chains to reduce import dependency. India’s annual defence production reached an all-time high of Rs 1.78 lakh crore in FY 2025-26, showing a 15.6% growth over the previous fiscal. Defence PSUs accounted for 76% of total production, while the private sector contributed 24% as of FY 2025-26. India is now exporting defence equipment to more than 80 countries, and defence R&D allocation rose over 112% to Rs. 29,100.25 crore in 2026-27. The Indian Army achieved roughly 91% self-sufficiency by indigenising 159 out of 175 ammunition variants. Major recent achievements include successful tests of the Agni-4, Agni-5, TARA Glide Weapon, RudraM-II, and the Kusha Long Range Air Defence Missile. Two defence industrial corridors in Uttar Pradesh and Tamil Nadu have attracted significant investment commitments by April 2026. Challenges remain in areas like jet engines, semiconductors, cyber warfare, and advanced sensors, which require sustained investment and technological sovereignty.

When: 2026-10-26 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Raksha Mantri Shri Rajnath Singh · **Prelims:** India's defence production reached Rs 1.78 lakh crore in FY 2025-26.; India exports defence equipment to more than 80 countries.; The Indian Army achieved roughly 91% self-sufficiency by indigenising 159 out of 175 ammunition variants.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reduces foreign exchange outflow and import dependence for critical military hardware.; Strengthens the domestic industrial base, involving DPSUs, MSMEs, and private industry.*

Static — Defence Acquisition Procedure (DAP) guides the procurement of weapons and systems for India's armed forces, focusing on domestic manufacturing. Positive Indigenisation Lists restrict the import of specified military equipment and spares to encourage domestic defence manufacturing under Atmanirbhar Bharat. Defence Industrial Corridors in Uttar Pradesh and Tamil Nadu are set up to develop specialized manufacturing clusters, test facilities, and supply chains for the defence sector.

Syllabus: GS3: Defence, Governance & Policy

PIB: read the source · free copy on nextias.com

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY PLACE IN NEWS QUICK READ

Maharashtra wildlife board approves sanctuary status for two forest areas, 14 conservation reserves

The Maharashtra State Board for Wildlife approved proposals to declare two forest areas as wildlife sanctuaries and 14 areas across seven districts as conservation reserves. The decisions were taken during the 26th meeting of the board, which was chaired by Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis. The Kolamarka Conservation Reserve in Gadchiroli district, known for its wild buffaloes, was approved for elevation to a wildlife sanctuary.

The Hindu: source

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

TDB-DST signs agreement with Manastu Space for Rs. 116 crore RDI support to advance indigenous green propulsion technology

The Technology Development Board under the Department of Science and Technology signed an agreement with Manastu Space Technologies. The agreement provides financial assistance of 116 crore rupees under the Research, Development and Innovation Fund. The total estimated project cost is 277.63 crore rupees to advance indigenous green propulsion technology for satellites and launch vehicles.

PIB: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Supreme Court reserves verdict on Ayodhya housing scheme land acquisition

The Supreme Court reserved its verdict on a petition challenging land acquisition for a residential housing scheme in Ayodhya. The Shri Saryu Nagar Vikas Samiti appealed against an August 6 Allahabad High Court order regarding compensation and rehabilitation. The core dispute involves whether authorities must apply all statutory safeguards under the Right to Fair Compensation Act, 2013, beyond just monetary relief.

indiatoday.in: source

ECONOMY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Department of Commerce Extends RELIEF Initiative under Export Promotion Mission Until March 31, 2027

The Department of Commerce extended timelines under Component II of the RELIEF initiative until March 31, 2027. The extension was driven by continuing geopolitical disruptions in West Asia and attacks on maritime logistics across the Gulf. The core issue is protecting Indian exporters from extraordinary freight cost escalation, higher insurance premiums, and war-related export risks.

PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | QUICK READ

TRAI releases Recommendations on ‘Authorisation Framework for Application-based Linear Television Distribution (ALTD) Services’

TRAI has recommended mandatory government authorisation for apps and platforms providing Application-based Linear Television Distribution (ALTD) services. The Ministry of Information and Broadcasting requested a regulatory framework on December 15, 2025, to ensure parity, content accountability, and consumer protection. The core issue involves regulating Internet-based platforms that aggregate and distribute scheduled linear TV channels to smart TVs and mobile devices.

PIB: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

From bird havens to flood buffers: India’s expanding Ramsar network puts wetlands in focus

India's Ramsar network of wetlands of international importance has expanded from 26 sites in 2014 to 103 sites covering over 13.87 lakh hectares. The Union Environment Ministry announced the latest additions on October 15, 2026: Sukhna Wetland in Chandigarh and Sauj Jheel in Uttar Pradesh. Sukhna Wetland is a 1958-created reservoir at the Shivalik foothills serving the Central Asian Flyway, while Sauj Jheel in Mainpuri regularly hosts over 30,000 waterbirds.

ddnews.gov.in: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Keralam Assembly unanimously passes Senior Citizens’ (Care and Protection of Rights) Bill

Keralam became the first state in India to pass a comprehensive law to protect senior citizens from abuse and exploitation. The Keralam Senior Citizens (Care and Protection of Rights) Bill, 2026, was passed unanimously by the state Assembly on Monday. Chief Minister V D Satheesan accepted several amendments moved by members of both ruling and opposition benches.

The Hindu: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Assam Cabinet Approves Amendment to Mineral Regulation and Trading Rules

The Assam Cabinet approved a gazette notification for the Assam Mineral Regulation and Trading (Amendment) Rules, 2026. The update aims to strengthen the regulation, monitoring, and management of the state's mineral resources. The core issue addressed is improving mineral extraction, transportation oversight, and systematic grade identification. The amendment introduces a grade-wise classification of minerals, specifically focusing on iron ore and limestone.

sentinelassam.com: source

HISTORY, ART & CULTURE | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

UNESCO Tentative List 2026, 3 Indian Sites Added, Total Reaches 81

Three new Indian sites were added to UNESCO's World Heritage Tentative List in September 2026, raising the country's total to 81. The additions include the Karst-mud-volcano Complex of Baratang, the Andaman Subduction Volcanoes, and the Sirpur Cultural and Archaeological Landscape. These inclusions highlight India's diverse geological formations, ancient temples, Buddhist monasteries, and rich archaeological heritage.

Vajiram & Ravi: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | QUICK READ

Deputy Chairman, Rajya Sabha, Shri Harivansh Addresses Plenary Session of 12th BRICS Parliamentary Forum in New Delhi

Rajya Sabha Deputy Chairman Shri Harivansh delivered the welcome address at the 12th BRICS Parliamentary Forum in New Delhi. The forum was held under the inaugural session theme 'Fostering Parliaments for People-Centric Development' and focused on sustainability. Harivansh noted that BRICS represents about 49.5 per cent of the global population and serves as a vital platform for cooperation.

PIB: source

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

ISRO NVS-03 Mission 2026, Launch Date, Features and Significance

The Indian Space Research Organisation is preparing to launch the GSLV-F18 rocket carrying the NVS-03 navigation satellite on October 30, 2026. The mission is scheduled from the Satish Dhawan Space Centre in Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh. The core objective is to strengthen India's indigenous Navigation with Indian Constellation system and reduce dependence on foreign systems.

Vajiram & Ravi: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | QUICK READ

Supreme Court notice to ECI on plea against Maharashtra SIR deletions

The Supreme Court sought the response of the Election Commission of India on a petition challenging the special intensive revision exercise in Maharashtra. The petitioner requested an interim direction to keep the process in abeyance until the court decides the issue, ahead of the final roll publication on November 6.

Hindustan Times: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | QUICK READ

Rubio to host G20 Foreign Ministers' meet in Atlanta on Oct 30-31

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio will host the G20 Foreign Ministers Meeting in Atlanta on October 30-31. External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar is scheduled to attend the upcoming G20 Foreign Ministers meeting. The meeting aims to strengthen practical cooperation on shared economic and security challenges before the leaders meeting.

The Hindu: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | EXERCISE | QUICK READ

Exercise "Keen Sword 27"

The United States and Japan launched Exercise Keen Sword 27, marking the largest joint field-training military exercise in their shared history. The biennial multi-domain joint field training exercise aims to increase combat readiness, tactical synchronization, and bilateral defense interoperability. The historic mobilization involves approximately 56,000 Japanese and US military personnel supported by warships, submarines, and combat aircraft.

Insights on India: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | QUICK READ

AJK Cabinet Approves Special Courts For Overseas Kashmiris, Gemstone Centres And Sports Funding

The cabinet meeting chaired in AJK resulted in these newly announced administrative and legislative approvals. The Azad Jammu and Kashmir cabinet approved the creation of special courts for overseas Kashmiris, alongside funding for gemstone centres and sports.

UrduPoint: source

ECONOMY | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

China's proposed export curbs threaten India's solar cell manufacturing plans

Industry reports highlighted that China's upcoming export curbs could disrupt India's solar manufacturing push and policy timelines. China's proposed export controls on photovoltaic technologies threaten India's domestic solar cell manufacturing plans and supply chains. These restrictions may lead to delays and increased costs for domestic players aiming for backward integration in manufacturing. The Approved List of Models and Manufacturers Phase II policy timelines could also be disrupted as a result.

Economic Times: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

Monthly Flash Report on Central Sector Infrastructure Projects tracks 1,853 Infrastructure Projects worth Rs. 37.56 lakh crore as of September 2026

The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) released its monthly Flash Report for September 2026. The report tracks 1,853 central sector infrastructure projects each costing Rs 150 crore and above. The combined revised cost of these monitored infrastructure projects stands at Rs 37.56 lakh crore. The number of monitored projects increased from 1,731 in August to 1,853 in September, with costs rising from Rs 33.60 lakh crore.

PIB: source

ECONOMY | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

MoSPI to start annual unincorporated sector enterprises survey from April 2027

The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation announced that the Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises 2027-28 will run from April 2027 to March 2028. The survey period is shifting from the calendar year to the financial year to align with other surveys like the Annual Survey of Industries. New policy-focused questions are being added to capture gender-specific constraints faced by female entrepreneurs for the first time.

Economic Times: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

MoRTH to Organise ‘Transport Mela’ under PARIVARTAN Scheme in Delhi-NCR on 28th October, 2026

MoRTH announced that the Transport Mela will be held on 28 October 2026 at Burari, North Delhi. The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways is organising a Transport Mela under the PARIVARTAN Scheme in Delhi-NCR to promote the replacement of old trucks and buses with cleaner vehicles.

PIB: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | APPOINTMENT | QUICK READ

SC collegium recommends four judges for appointment as High Court chief justices

The Supreme Court Collegium has recommended four high court judges for appointment as chief justices of various high courts. The recommendations were made in a resolution passed on Monday by the collegium. The collegium is headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant along with justices Vikram Nath and BV Nagarathna.

Bar & Bench: source

ECONOMY | ACT/BILL/RULES | DAY/OBSERVANCE | QUICK READ

Sarbananda Sonowal Woos Korean Firms for Indias Shipyards, Seeks Global Shipping Rules All Can Follow

Union Minister Sarbananda Sonowal urged global maritime forums in Busan for universal maritime rules that accommodate varying national circumstances and capabilities. The push aims to secure foreign partners, specifically South Korean marine equipment manufacturers, to build and grow India's shipbuilding and shipping sector. India argued that international standards must remain ambitious while recognizing differences in national development, technology, and access to finance under CBDR.

PIB: source

DISASTER MANAGEMENT | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

Cyclone Arnab: Affected people in AP can report emergencies via Mana Mitra WhatsApp service

The service was launched to assist citizens in reporting cyclone-related issues such as power outages and waterlogging during Cyclone Arnab. The Andhra Pradesh government has launched the Mana Mitra WhatsApp service to allow people affected by Cyclone Arnab to report emergencies. People can report power outages, fallen trees, collapsed walls, waterlogging and other cyclone-related issues by sending “Hi” to 9552300009 on WhatsApp

BusinessLine: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | REPORT/INDEX | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Census (Amendment) Rules, 2026 reg. appointment of Teachers, Clerks, any person etc as Enumerator: Notification

A notification regarding the Census (Amendment) Rules, 2026 was issued concerning the appointment of enumerators. The Census (Amendment) Rules, 2026 have been notified, enabling the appointment of teachers, clerks, and any person as enumerators for census duties.

Staff News: source

ECONOMY | QUICK READ

Bangladesh Surpasses India in Per Capita GDP but IMF Forecasts Change

Bangladesh's per capita GDP is projected to be higher than India's this year, according to the International Monetary Fund. The projected 2026 per capita GDP is $2,886 for Bangladesh and $2,749 for India. India's overall GDP remains nearly eight times larger than that of Bangladesh at $4.15 trillion compared to $506.4bn. Experts attribute Bangladesh's rise to its $38bn garment industry, remittances, and growing participation of women in the workforce.

aljazeera.com: source

DEFENCE EXERCISE QUICK READ

Indian Navy Completes Joint Exercise With Maldives Coast Guard

The successful completion of the joint exercise was reported on October 26, 2026. The Indian Navy and Maldives Coast Guard concluded a joint military exercise aimed at enhancing bilateral maritime cooperation.

https://defence.newsd.in/: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS3 Beyond Kudankulam's fence, a cybersecurity challenge

India's critical infrastructure increasingly relies on external contractors, cloud platforms, and data centres, extending cybersecurity risks far beyond physical plant boundaries. In July 2026, ransomware group World Leaks claimed a breach of nearly 19,000 files totalling 14.3 GB linked to Kudankulam, hosted via Yotta by Reliance Infrastructure. NPCIL clarified that the leaked material concerned non-nuclear infrastructure, leaving reactor controls and nuclear safety systems uncompromised. Attackers increasingly exploit less-protected third-party vendors and shared credentials as entry points rather than targeting heavily guarded direct facilities.

The Hindu

GS3 Mint Quick Edit | Gig workers to be counted in the Periodic Labour Force Survey—a welcome decision

The announcement regarding the inclusion of gig workers in the official survey from 2027 has drawn positive editorial commentary. The decision to include gig workers in the Periodic Labour Force Survey from 2027 onwards is a welcome step towards better labor data collection. From 2027 onwards, policymakers may have access to official data about gig workers from a nationally representative survey. Here are two tweaks that could help monetary policymakers.

Mint

GS3 We need to address the issue of soil health. Four steps can improve the situation

Of the 96 lakh soil samples tested under the Soil Health Card scheme in 2025-26, 72 per cent were low in nitrogen and 52 per cent in organic carbon. Carbon-starved soils cannot retain applied nitrogen, leading to low crop uptake while the rest escapes as nitrous oxide or leaches into groundwater. Nutrient deficiencies in soils reduce crop resistance, lower grain quality, and contribute to hidden hunger in the population.

msn.com

GS2 Special intensive revision: What's the road ahead for the Election Commission of India?

The Election Commission of India refused to reveal the name and version of the software used to identify errors during the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls. The poll body cited exemptions under Section 8(1)(d) of the Right to Information Act, stating the information involves commercial confidence, trade secrets, and intellectual property. The core issue revolves around transparency in the voter data revision process and whether automated or AI systems are leading to wrongful exclusions of voters.

Mint

GS2 A Ready Solution to Tackle Anaemia

Anaemia affects over half of Indian women and almost three-fourths of children, yet Double Fortified Salt remains underused. The inclusion of DFS in the Public Distribution System is uneven because its implementation is left entirely to State governments. Iron-deficiency anaemia causes maternal deaths, intergenerational malnutrition, impaired cognitive development, and lost productivity. DFS is salt fortified with both iodine and iron, solving sustained compliance because virtually every household consumes salt daily.

The Hindu

GS3 Yes Bank AT-1 bonds: Who will examine administrator's role?

The Supreme Court upheld the Bombay High Court's decision setting aside the permanent write-down of Rs 8,415 crore of Yes Bank AT-1 bonds. The judgment dismissed appeals by Yes Bank, the Reserve Bank of India, and the Union of India, settling the legality of the write-down. The core issue focuses on institutional accountability and examining the decision-making circumstances when an administrator's action is held unlawful.

Economic Times

GS3 At COP, a move from climate learning to climate action

The author argues that climate change education (CCE) must shift from mere awareness generation to competency-driven action and transformation. International environmental action was catalysed by the 1972 UN conference, leading to constitutional duties and the landmark 1991 Supreme Court M C Mehta judgment in India. Climate literacy has been integrated into Indian education through the NEP 2020, NCF-SE 2023, Mission LiFE, and UGC undergraduate environment guidelines. Globally, countries like Italy and New Jersey have integrated sustainability into school curricula, backed by UNESCO's Greening Education Partnership.

msn.com

GS2 A southern alliance and an elephant in the room

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu seeks to forge an informal southern alliance with Tamil Nadu, Telangana, Karnataka, and Kerala. The proposed bloc aims to build a $10 trillion-plus economy by the year 2047. The five southern states together account for less than a fifth of India's population but over 31 per cent of its GDP. Major structural weaknesses hide this economic heft, beginning with rapidly ageing populations across the region.

msn.com

GS2 The growing footprint of geography on strategy

The Iran war and the closure of the Strait of Hormuz exposed India's vulnerability as its economy runs almost entirely on global trade routes it cannot control. The erosion of global commons, American reticence, and attacks on critical infrastructure like the Red Sea and undersea cables have made strategic geography uncertain. Global powers are actively shaping transit corridors, including Beijing's Belt and Road, Moscow's INSTC, and Washington-backed routes.

Hindustan Times

GS2 When dissent becomes a crime: Karnataka High Court draws the line

The Karnataka High Court quashed an FIR against 13 people accused of painting slogans on a wall in Mangaluru in 2019. The accused had described a Supreme Court judgment as a denial of justice and urged people to raise a voice. Justice H P Sandesh held that disagreement with a judicial verdict does not amount to promoting enmity or criminal conspiracy. The editorial highlights that the institutional impulse to treat dissent as a law-and-order issue survives political changes.

Deccan Herald

GS3 Nageswaran & Poojari: Let's welcome data centres—but on the right terms

Global AI hyperscalers are increasingly setting their sights on India to establish massive data centres. The authors examine the rising interest of AI hyperscalers in India and caution that the country must weigh commitment costs against benefits before committing scarce resources. The terms must be settled before we pay in advance.

Mint

GS2 A parliamentary push to the BRICS agenda

India assumed the BRICS Chairship in 2026 under the theme Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability, anchoring its agenda in a humanity-first framework. The 12th BRICS Parliamentary Forum is being hosted in New Delhi by the Parliament of India under the theme Fostering Parliaments for People-centric Development. The author argues that while international summits articulate shared commitments, parliaments provide the necessary legislative mechanisms to translate these into domestic policies.

Hindustan Times

GS2 Citizens have two months to save democracy

Triggered by concerns over the refusal of key officials to resign and the limited options available to opposition parties. An opinion piece arguing that a crucial two-month window remains for citizens to intervene and protect democratic electoral processes. Gyanesh Kumar will not resign, and the BJP won’t let him. The opposition can’t boycott the ECI or the elections. The window to prevent electoral authoritarianism is closing fast.

Frontline

GS3 Starlink episode points to tightropes in changing political economy

Elon Musk accused Reliance Industries of acting like an oligarch by blocking Starlink from entering India's satellite broadband market. The Union government stated that Starlink must undergo the same regulatory requirements and clearance procedures as all other rival firms. The core debate centers on whether India's liberalised economy is truly open to new competitors or still burdened by structural entry barriers. Historical legacy of the licence-permit raj created an environment where navigating the state and obtaining political access became sources of competitive advantage.

civilsdaily.com

GS2 Dubious retreat: on the National Medical Commission and its MSMER

It is in the news due to debates and concerns surrounding the National Medical Commission and its regulatory standards. The editorial discusses the National Medical Commission and its Minimum Standard Requirements, expressing concern over perceived laxity in medical education regulation. The National Medical Commission must not be seen as lax on regulation

The Hindu

GS3 From field to market: The farmer without a title

The UN has declared 2026 the International Year of the Woman Farmer, while the Bharatiya Kisan Sangh brought women farmers to Delhi on September 30 to demand recognition. PLFS 2025 data shows women make up 45 percent of India's agricultural workforce, numbering about 12 crore workers. Despite high workforce participation, the last Agriculture Census recorded only 13.96 percent of land holdings and 11.72 percent of area in women's names.

Economic Times

GS3 India-Canada CEPA: What Indian manufacturing needs

Canada trade minister Maninder Sidhu visited India with around 300 business delegates following the fifth round of Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement negotiations in Ottawa. Both governments aim to conclude the CEPA by the end of the year, with Prime Minister Narendra Modi expected to visit Canada in December. Bilateral merchandise trade between India and Canada stood at $7.95 billion in 2025-26, reflecting an 8.2% decline from the previous fiscal year.

Hindustan Times

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

Odisha's contempt petition in Supreme Court over Kotia panchayat election The Odisha government filed a contempt of court petition in the Supreme Court against the Andhra Pradesh government. The petition challenges a notification issued by Andhra Pradesh to conduct Zilla Parishad and Panchayat Samiti elections in the disputed Kotia region.
The Hindu

Explained: Why the Supreme Court may be having too many Special Leave Petitions The persistent rise in judicial backlog and pendency caused by a high volume of SLPs keeps this topic constantly relevant. This explainer examines the mounting burden of Special Leave Petitions on the Supreme Court of India and the debate over its role.
Indian Express

What is Indonesia doing in the Badr Pact with Pakistan, Turkey and Qatar? Recent reports highlighting Indonesia's participation in the Badr Pact put the alliance in focus. An explainer detailing Indonesia's involvement in the Badr Pact alongside Pakistan, Turkey, and Qatar.
Firstpost

India-Poland Relations – Significance & Challenges Polish Prime Minister Donald Tusk's visit to India provided fresh momentum to bilateral ties and strengthened India's engagement with Europe. India and Poland established diplomatic relations in 1954 based on shared anti-colonial sympathies and support for peaceful coexistence.
ForumIAS

What Lula's Brazil Victory Means For India: BRICS, Trade And The Global South Prime Minister Narendra Modi congratulated Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva on his victory in Brazil's run-off election for a fourth non-consecutive presidential term. Lula defeated right-wing senator Flavio Bolsonaro, marking a rejection of right-wing trends and US President Donald Trump's policies in South America.
hindustantimes.com

Maharashtra SIR: Why are more than 2.07 crore enumeration forms 'uncollected'? Questions arose regarding the large number of uncollected enumeration forms during the Special Intensive Revision. An explanation of the electoral roll revision process in Maharashtra and the timeline for claims and objections. It is to be noted that August 17 is not the final deadline.
The Hindu

Why Rs 190 crore post-flood Loss and Damage Fund payout to Nepal matters The payout became news following the disbursement of funds to assist Nepal's recovery from severe climate-induced flooding. Nepal received a Rs 190 crore payout from the international Loss and Damage Fund to cope with heavy post-flood destruction.
Indian Express

Knowledge Nugget | Kashipur Excavations: What links the site to the Mahabharata and Xuanzang? Recent archaeological interest and findings surrounding the Kashipur excavations put the ancient site in the news. This explainer details the archaeological significance of Kashipur and its historical connections to the epic Mahabharata and Chinese pilgrim Xuanzang's accounts. Why is the ASI excavating a 90-acre mound in Kashipur?
Indian Express

Farming under solar panels: Can agrivoltaics work in India without hurting crop yields? The approach is in the news as policymakers explore sustainable land-use models to expand solar capacity without displacing food crops. Agrivoltaics is the simultaneous use of land for agricultural production and solar photovoltaic power generation, balancing energy needs with farming.
Indian Express

How did Lula overturn a first-round defeat to win Brazil's presidential election, and what challenges await? It appeared as an explainer following the conclusion of Brazil's presidential election. This article explains how Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva overcame a first-round defeat to win Brazil's presidential election and outlines the upcoming challenges.
Indian Express

How are tropical cyclones named? Cyclone Arnab is named under the official system used to identify tropical cyclones developing over the North Indian Ocean. Bangladesh proposed the name Arnab, which is officially included in the list adopted in April 2020. The naming list was adopted by the World Meteorological Organisation (WMO) and the UN ESCAP Panel on Tropical Cyclones.
The Hindu

Brazil election: 2 reasons Lula trumped predictions of defeat to win historic fourth term The conclusion of the Brazil election and Lula da Silva's historic victory put this topic in the news. Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva won a historic fourth term in the Brazilian presidential election, defying predictions of his defeat.
Indian Express

Israel elections: Why only coalitions have ruled so far, could this time be different The persistent political instability and coalition dynamics in Israel brought its electoral system into focus. An explainer on why Israel has never been ruled by a single party and always relied on coalition governments.
Indian Express

Where should judicial restraint begin? The persistent debate over the limits of judicial intervention in policy and governance issues. An explainer analyzing the debate between judicial restraint and judicial activism within the Indian constitutional framework.
Civilsdaily

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- LOK SABHA SPEAKER URGES BRICS PARLIAMENTS TO CHAMPION ETHICAL, RESPONSIBLE, AND TRANSPARENT TECHNOLOGY WITH PARAMOUNT HUMAN OVERSIGHT (International Relations) PIB
- Shah Bano Case Explained: Landmark Supreme Court Judgment (Polity & Constitution) jeevanutsahnews.in
- Keralam plans Bill to regulate high treatment costs in private hospitals (Health) The Hindu
- Cost of Fertiliser Imbalance in India (Agriculture & Allied) ForumIAS
- Brazil's incumbent President Lula defeats Flavio Bolsonaro to win a historic fourth term (International Relations) Hindustan Times
- IITs have far fewer mental health counsellors than recommended by UGC: RTI data (Education) The Hindu
- Agrivoltaics in India: Grow Crops and Generate Solar Power (Agriculture & Allied) Vajiram & Ravi
- Cabinet Secretary chairs a meeting of National Crisis Management Committee (NCMC) to review preparedness for the impending cyclone in Bay of Bengal (Disaster Management) PIB
- Rajnath Singh to lead Indian team at ASEAN Defence Ministers' Meeting in Philippines (International Relations) The Hindu
- Operation Trident of NCB (Internal Security) ForumIAS
- Soil Health in India Challenges and the Way Forward (Agriculture & Allied) ForumIAS
- RTE Act mandates short school distances, but most students commute longer: govt. data (Governance & Policy) The Hindu
- Pratt & Whitney signs over $40 million in supply agreements with Indian firms (Economy) BusinessLine
- Integrated Atmospheric Chemistry and Aerosol Toxicity Analysis Laboratory (AATAL) (Science & Technology) ForumIAS
- FIRST TRAINING SQUADRON OF THE INDIAN NAVY ARRIVES AT COLOMBO, SRI LANKA (International Relations) Economic Times
- Osbeckia assamensis (Environment & Ecology) Vajiram & Ravi
- UP Agriculture Export Policy, 2019 (Amended 2021): Incentives, eligibility, implementation (Agriculture & Allied) Business Standard
- 11 Crore Digital Identity Cards Created under the Digital Agriculture Mission (Agriculture & Allied) NEXT IAS
- GSMA Digital Nations Index 2026: Singapore Leads Asia Pacific, India Ranks Ninth as AI and Cybersecurity Investments Grow (Economy) TelecomLead
- Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM), Objectives, Achievements, JJM 2.0 (Governance & Policy) Vajiram & Ravi
- Indian Air Force Pilots Fly Su-30SM Fighter for the First Time in a Russian Exercise (Defence) Defensemirror.com
- Gauhati University botanists discover new flowering species in Manas National Park (Environment & Ecology) Hub News
- Over 2.3 Crore Gig Workers By 2030: India Tweaking Its Labour Survey Methods (Economy) NDTV
- CoC Cannot Withdraw Approved Resolution Plan: Supreme Court Rejects Plea Citing Improved Finances (Economy) LawChakra
- ECI rejects unilateral action charge against CEC Gyanesh Kumar, tells Supreme Court all three SIR orders w (Polity & Constitution) The Economic Times
- ECI files affidavit in Supreme Court, says all SIR orders issued between 2025-26 were "unanimous" (Polity & Constitution) ANI News
- Tiger walks into Beed`s forests in Maharashtra for the first time since the 1910s (Environment & Ecology) Mid-Day
- IMF Big Forecast: Global Inflation to Fall, India's Growth Outlook Remains Strong (Economy) Tatsat Chronicle
- Tigress relocated to West Bengal's Buxa tiger reserve moves into Assam's Raimona National Park (Environment & Ecology) India Today NE
- BRICS Bharat Innovates Exposition being held on September 11-12, 2026 as part of 18th BRICS Summit at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi (International Relations) Press Information Bureau
- Supreme Court rejects gaming firms' review pleas, upholds Tamil Nadu and Karnataka online gaming bans (Polity & Constitution) The Economic Times
- Compare the processes of laterisation, podzolisation and calcification in soil formation. Bring out the influence of climate and vegetation on these processes, with reference to their geographical distribution. (Geography) Insights on India
- First batch of 18k Agniveers set to leave forces by Dec 31, focus now on second career opportunities (Defence) Hindustan Times
- The Sundarbans at the crossroads of climate change and human survival [Commentary] (Environment & Ecology) Mongabay India
- NITI Aayog pushes for empowered city governments, elected mayors to tackle urbanisation challenges (Governance & Policy) Rediff
- Beyond Bars: Why Supreme Court's Landmark Ruling On Grounds Of Arrest Is Triumph For Constitutionalism (Polity & Constitution) Live Law
- UN Reform 2026: Challenges, Proposals and India's Role (International Relations) StudyIQ
- Face-Offs at India-China Border Are Continuing at Multiple Points, ITBP Chief Confirms (Internal Security) The Diplomat
- Ex-Army Captain Arrested For Sharing Defence Information With Partner (Internal Security) NDTV
- UP man spent 6 years in jail for murder despite not being named in FIR. SC orders Rs. 6 lakh compensation (Polity & Constitution) Hindustan Times
- 'Travesty of justice': SC flays UP Police for 'slipshod probe' in murder case, orders reparation for undertrial (Polity & Constitution) Times of India
- Nearly half of reef-building corals face extinction risk: study (Environment & Ecology) China Daily
- Very severe cyclone 'Arnab' to make landfall near Yanam-Kakinada; red alert issued for seven districts (Disaster Management) The Hindu

• Plea before Supreme Court against Tripura customary law allowing settlement of rape cases by paying fine (Polity & Constitution) Bar & Bench

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 14 must-know, 25 Prelims facts, 44 in the news, 17 editorials, 14 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Polity & Constitution (10), International Relations (8), Economy (7), Defence (3), Governance & Policy (3), Environment & Ecology (2), Science & Technology (2), Social Justice & Welfare (1), History, Art & Culture (1), Infrastructure & Energy (1), Disaster Management (1). **Nothing today in —** Health, Education, Agriculture & Allied, Internal Security, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 3 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 1 · Political change in the neighbourhood: nothing today · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 1 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 2

Full text — 47 of 70 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 10, PIB 9, Indian Express 7, msn.com 4, Hindustan Times 4, Economic Times 4, Mint 3, BusinessLine 2, Bar & Bench 2, Vajiram & Ravi 2, Al Jazeera 1, newsx.com 1, Business Standard 1, Lawtext 1

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